CARD 4 | Amazon Q Developer, July 2025

The pull request that reached the release

What was reported

- A person using the handle lkmanka58 submitted a pull request to Amazon's open-source repository for the Amazon Q Developer extension for VS Code, containing a prompt telling the assistant to delete local files and cloud resources.
- The change was merged and shipped in version 1.84.0 on 17 July 2025.
- AWS's security bulletin said the code was incorrectly formatted and did not run as intended, that no customer resources were affected, and that it revoked and replaced credentials and released version 1.85.0. Reports put the extension at close to a million installations.
- Reports differ on when AWS acknowledged the issue (19 July in one account, 23 July in others). The formatting flaw, not a control, stopped the instructions from running.

The question for your pair

The thing that was changed was a prompt, and it was changed by a stranger. Which line of a configuration record would have shown it, and who reviews a change to a prompt?

Write your control on a sticky note, then stick this card on the Incident Wall.

Sources: AWS security bulletin (19 July 2025) as reported by AWS Insider (25 July 2025); CyberInsider; TechRepublic (28 July 2025); Red Hot Cyber (25 July 2025).